



Finance Planning
Mortgage & Protection



August 2025

**Continual
Professional
Development**

Welcome to the Finance Planning monthly round-up newsletter for August 2025,

I hope everyone enjoyed the summer holiday months and was able to take some well-deserved time off. With the arrival of September, we are nearly at the final quarter of the year so looking to really push on for the busiest year end possible. Thank you to those who came to the FPG Summer Conference hosted by Nationwide, for those that couldn't make it Pete confirmed some big news around product transfer processing so keep an eye on your email for some compliance news updates.

Hope everyone has a great September.

Thank you.

David



Compliance News 15/07 (Protection Sourcing – National Friendly)

Where you see National Friendly's protection products sourcing, please do not recommend them as they are not yet on panel with Finance Planning.

Compliance News 16/07 (LV B&C Property Assumptions)

When selling LV's B&C policies, a reminder of the importance to be reading the 'property assumptions' to a client, and to ensure they can positively answer all questions. The assumptions can be found on the personal illustration.

Fake FCA Scam Reports

The FCA has warned of fraudsters impersonating the FCA, with roughly 5,000 reports to their consumer helpline already this year. More worrying is that 10% of these reports have concerned victims who have been duped into sending money to the fraudster.

For clients and Advisers alike, you are unlikely to be contacted by the FCA. If you are, or a client contacts you because they have been, then please contact Pete Burgess. The FCA would never ask an individual to transfer money or reveal sensitive personal or banking information.

Financial Promotions, and the Advertising Standards Authority (ASA)

It is so important for all of your online materials to be approved before they are posted. Not only do we have FCA rules to comply with, but also those of the ASA. This matter has recently been highlighted because the ASA have heavily criticised Lloyds for one of their recent advertising campaigns which the ASA deemed as being 'misleading'.

Conditional Selling

Conditional selling is where an estate agent requires a buyer to use their in-house mortgage broker in order to have their offer considered or accepted on a property. The matter has been highlighted again with the [not so] recent BBC Panorama programme. Conditional selling is illegal under the Estate Agents Act 1979, which requires that every offer for a property must be given to the seller. Where a client is concerned about conditional selling, here's a suggestion of what we can say to help the client:-

1. Offer the estate agent the DIP/AIP which you have given them as this signals they are financially prepared without having to rely on the agent's in-house services
2. Document all communications with the estate agent, and keep any texts or emails which pressurises them into using specific services
3. Refer to the Estate Agents Act 1979 and the Property Ombudsman's Code when confronted with conditional selling
4. Report any misconduct, initially to the estate agent's senior management, and then if necessary the client can escalate a complaint to The Property Ombudsman, Trading Standards or Citizens Advice.
5. By using a mortgage broker, or solicitor, outside of the estate agency's it panel can often better protect the client's own interests.

Motor Finance Supreme Court Ruling

You will have seen in the press that the Supreme Court has largely overturned last year's Court of Appeal judgement, which allowed redress where a relationship is deemed 'unfair' – more specifically (in this case) a car finance agreement where much of the cost is undisclosed commission.

Most importantly for the finance industry, (rather than consumers!), is significantly reduced consumer compensation payouts, and there is unlikely to now be a knock-on effect in other areas, for instance charging a mortgage advice fee on the strength of an unsigned IDD.

Because of the high-level reporting of this matter, we reviewed our own existing 'fair value assessments' and we are comfortable with (i) our maximum charging structure of £999 for retail mortgages, and (ii) of the rationale and reasonability of each Adviser's own fee scale within this parameter. Meanwhile, Advisers are reminded to stick to their own fee scale and be charging the same fee levels for each client type, for instance, all FTBuyers being charged £x and all complex cases being charged £y.

HMRC's Making Tax Digital Self-Assessments

HMRC's Making Tax Digital (MTD) programme is introducing a significant change to the way income tax self-assessment is reported to HMRC. It is anticipated that this may impact affordability assessments, income verification and the documentation necessary to assist with a self-employed client's mortgage application. As lenders update their packaging requirements, we'll report further and update our Mortgage Advice Standards and record keeping requirement, as necessary.

Fraud Prevention – Use of Professional Registers

To assist you in evidencing an individual's income, there are many registers of professional persons to assist you, for instance to determine if the client really is a solicitor, accountant, financial adviser, doctor, nurse, dentist, etc. You can google the relevant occupation register and then search for the client. If it is a genuine employment, then it should be listed together with their start date in most instances. This is particularly important for NHS workers as the NHS is the UK's largest employer with over 2 million employees, and so NHS payslips are commonly created as dummy payslips in staged income applications.

Record Keeping

There is an MCOB rule which says that Advisers must assess an individual's affordability before placing a case with a lender (with a similar rule under ICOB for insurance). To do this we complete a Budget Planner as part of the fact-find. Therefore, it's really important that the budget planner is a true reflection of your client's income and expenditure.

Unfortunately, we are seeing too many cases where the budget planner is poorly completed – either simply using pre-populated ONS data and/or not having any correlation to the outgoings on the client's own bank statements. Please therefore spend an extra minute or so correctly completing this important part of the fact-find, as without it you are not complying with FCA rules.

protectionnews

We recently heard from a broker who shared a touching story that highlights the human side of our industry.

One of their clients had a Critical Illness Cover (CIC) claim paid out, and upon contacting her lender—NatWest—they were informed that the Early Repayment Charges (ERCs) on her mortgage would be waived due to her circumstances. In an unexpected and thoughtful gesture, NatWest also sent the client a bouquet of flowers, acknowledging the difficult time she is facing.

It's heartening to see a lender not only do the right thing but go the extra mile to show compassion. In a world driven by numbers and policies, small acts of kindness like these remind us of the importance of empathy in financial services.

The broker added with a smile, *"I'll be up in Scotland next week and plan to hand-deliver my own bouquet—after all, you can never have too many flowers."*

mortgagenews

In this mortgage update we are minimising the number of product or specific criteria changes as you can review these from the vast array of emails you receive from lenders each day.

Stamp Duty

Paying enough stamp duty is very much in the spotlight at the moment so well worth reminding clients that they need to get advice from an appropriately qualified person and not rely on their conveyancer.

Proc Fee Payment Route

Please do NOT select PMS when applying for a mortgage. Please always select L&G Mortgage Cub, as we always have. (For your information, PMS are our protection service provider – Zenith PMS.)

performance

Mortgages – Adviser League Table for August 2025

Congratulations to **Rob Chart** for topping our table with 41 mortgage applications in August.

<u>Adviser</u>	<u>Cases</u>
Rob Chart	41
Pratima Gurung	33
Paul Gent	31
Dan Fletcher	23
Emily Chattaway	23
Andy Poustie	21
Carl Thorne	20
Claire Lipscomb	17
Jonathan Peachey	17
Phil James	17
Jack Savory	15
Dan Walsh	14
Joanne Pope	14
Cathy Rafferty	13
Pete Stickley	13
Ellis Featherbe	13
Graham Morris	13
Samita Rai	13
Jack Humphries	12
Richard Owen	12
Tim Dock	12
Paul Goodey	11
Paul Ripley	11
Phil Smith	11
Surakshya Rai	11
Jim Maye	11
Karen Mills	10
Joe White	10

Protection (protection and GI combined) – Adviser League Table for August 2025

Congratulations to **Paul Gent** for topping the protection table with 38 policies submitted.

<u>Adviser</u>	<u>Cases</u>
Paul Gent	38
Jane Hutchinson	28
Rob Chart	25
Clare Mann	25
Karen Mills	11

Congratulations to everyone who has featured on last month's league tables

Should anyone feel their applications are not being calculated properly, please speak to your Sales Manager as it might mean those cases you have submitted to a lender or insurer have not been recorded as such on Acre yet and we can show you how to fix that.



Well done to the following advisers who have all submitted million-pound cases this year. Lots of new entries this month so congratulations to all. Cases added in the last month are shown in [blue](#).

[Mortgage cases](#)

Paul Goodey	£3,881,250
Romi Pal	£3,207,525
Chris Williams	£2,377,875
Paul Goodey	£2,306,000
Wilma Scott	£1,762,500
Paul Goodey	£1,742,815
Paul Goodey	£1,629,776
Oliver Cunningham	£1,510,450
Paul Goodey	£1,500,000
Paul Ripley	£1,462,000
Joanne Pope	£1,454,540
Victoria Worthington	£1,410,000
Ellis Featherbe	£1,400,000
Romi Pal	£1,385,000
Phoebe Wight	£1,380,000
Ellis Featherbe	£1,370,000
Carrie Millin	£1,335,897
Victoria Wescott	£1,300,074
Paul Goodey	£1,300,000
Wilma Scott	£1,268,688
Trevor Farley	£1,237,393
Rob Chart	£1,234,503
Ellis Featherbe	£1,207,000
Paul Goodey	£1,207,000
Jonathon Peachey	£1,200,000
Marion Hunnisett	£1,125,000
Emily Chattaway	£1,170,000
Cathy Rafferty	£1,150,000
Phoebe Wight	£1,105,000
Joanne Pope	£1,083,660
Paul Goodey	£1,072,000
Claire Lipscomb	£1,067,698

Peter Stickley	£1,051,495
Cathy Rafferty	£1,020,000
Paul Goodey	£1,015,521
Jim Maye	£1,014,681
Karen Mills	£1,006,820
Joanne Pope	£1,005,699
Carrie Millin	£1,003,373
Paul Goodey	£1,001,054
Joanne Pope	£1,000,000

Protection cases

Dave Relfe	Exec IPB £3,838,800
Dave Relfe	Exec IPB £3,729,120
Paul Gent	Life £2,400,000
Victoria Wescott	Life £2,352,000
Paul Gent	IPB £2,339,073
Lorraine Smith	Life £1,560,790
Ellis Featherbe	Life £1,500,000
Paul Gent	Life £1,400,000
Paul Gent	Exec IPB £1,240,320
Paul Gent	Exec IPB £1,164,801
Paul Gent	IPB £1,128,204
Richard Lucy	Life £1,000,000
Dave Relfe	RLP £1,000,000
Dave Relfe	RLP £1,000,000
Paul Gent	Life £1,000,000

As with the mortgage and protection figures if you feel an application you have made should be referenced here, please speak to your sales manager to confirm if it is showing on Acre correctly.



FPG Anniversaries

So far in 2025 we have seen some very significant milestones reached in terms of service within the Finance Planning Group especially as this is the 25th year of The Finance Planning Group. A big thank you to everyone listed below for your hard work and dedication for however long you've been with us.

- Chris Bartrip – 22 years
- Dan Fletcher – 20 years
- Angela Yeats – 19 years

- Jane Hutchinson – 18 years
- Paul Goodey – 15 years
- Dave Jacob – 12 years
- Lorraine Smith – 10 years
- Carl Thorne – 7 years
- Peter Stickley – 7 years
- Nigel Urban – 7 years
- Hannah Logan-Hughes – 2 years
- Andrew Bramley – 2 years

I have been compiling these dates from several sources and have tried to be as accurate as possible but apologies in advance if anybody has been missed from this list that should have been recognised for a work anniversary please let me know so I can rectify it.

Upcoming Birthdays

Happy Birthday to everybody celebrating in September.

- Andy Poustie
- Bryce Protheroe
- Charlotte Haddow
- Claire Lipscomb
- Emily Chattaway
- James Hall
- Martin Ecroyd
- Martin Luffman
- Nigel Urban
- Smriti Pun
- Syd Martin
- Tim Dock
- Wilma Scott

New Arrivals

Everyone at Finance Planning would like to send a huge congratulations to several people who have welcomed brand new editions to their families in recent weeks. We look forward to welcoming you all back soon and best of luck with the new babies.

- Caitlin Ferguson and Ed
- Victoria Wescott and Andrew
- Chris Bowles and Chelsea

miscellaneous

Know Someone Who'd Make a Great Adviser?

FPG are always looking to find new people to join our team, and we know the best people to help grow our network are those already part of it. That's why we're introducing a scheme inviting you to recommend someone you know who'd make a great Mortgage & Protection Adviser. As someone who already shares our values and understands what it means to be part of the FPG network, your referrals are incredibly valuable. As a thank you, you'll receive £500 when your referral signs up, and a further £500 when they achieve competent adviser status. We believe FPG are in a great place to support advisers of nearly any experience in their careers and hopefully as someone already part of the network you would agree, if you have anyone you think might be suitable please don't hesitate to speak to your Sales Manager.

L&G Mortgage Club Roadshow – Lingfield Park – Wednesday 1st October

Our mortgage club will be holding their ever-popular roadshow at Lingfield Park Racecourse on 1st October. The event will run 9am-2:30pm and is an excellent source of CPD with many lenders attending as well as presentations on the market, technology, protection opportunities and more. There is no cost to attending and lunch is included. If you haven't already you can register for the event [here](https://www.legalandgeneral.com/adviser/mortgage-club/events/).

FPG Zoom Meetings

A reminder that our weekly zoom meetings hosted by Dan and Mark continue each Monday at 4pm. It's a great way to keep your knowledge updated and to gain the required CPD!

The sessions took a break in August but have been back since 1st September so come along if you can or watch the recordings as they are added to the Knowledge Hub - <https://knowledgehub.website/category/hangouts/>.

Digital Tax

Tax reporting is going digital, please look at the following flyer for some information to be aware of.

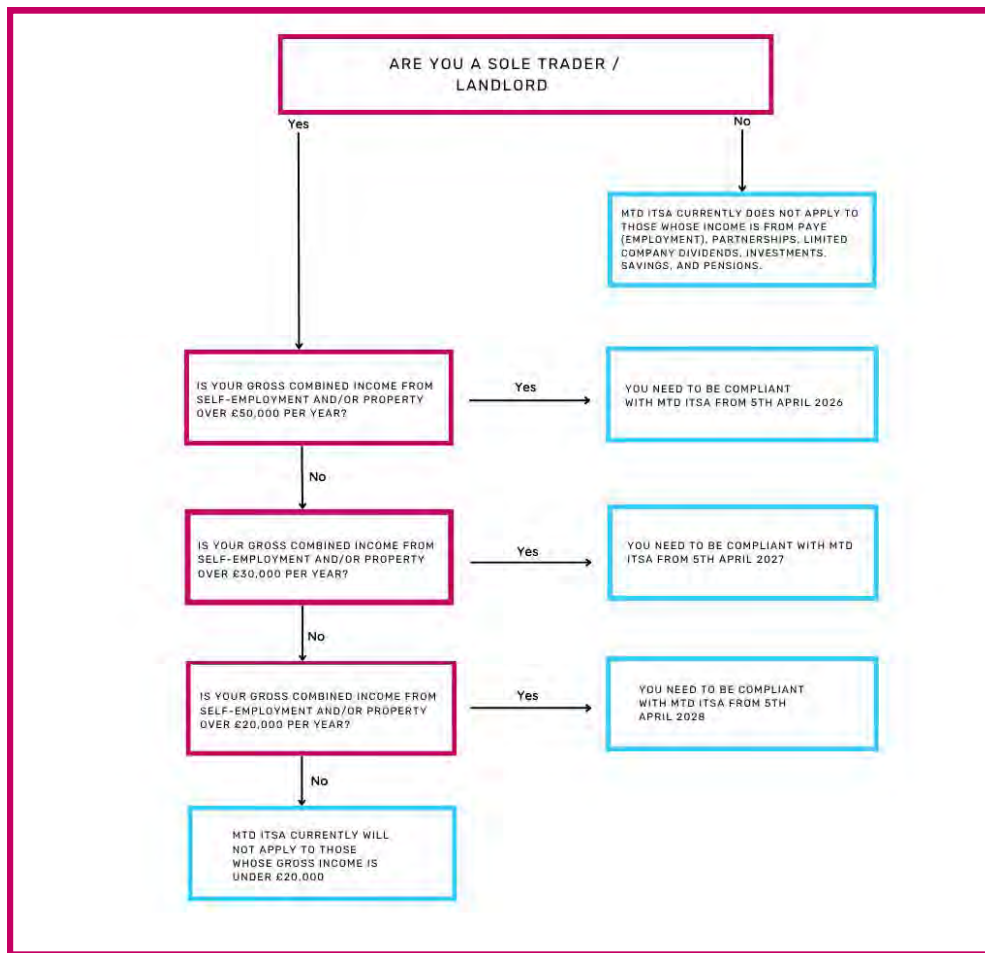
MAKING TAX DIGITAL - WHAT IT IS AND HOW IT AFFECTS YOU

MAKING TAX DIGITAL (MTD) IS A GOVERNMENT INITIATIVE AIMED AT MODERNISING THE UK TAX SYSTEM. IT REQUIRES BUSINESSES TO KEEP DIGITAL RECORDS AND SUBMIT TAX RETURNS USING HMRC-APPROVED SOFTWARE, RATHER THAN RELYING ON PAPER RECORDS OR SPREADSHEETS.

MTD WAS INTRODUCED TO IMPROVE ACCURACY, REDUCE ERRORS, AND MAKE TAX SUBMISSIONS MORE EFFICIENT. IT BEGAN IN 2019 WITH VAT-REGISTERED BUSINESSES OVER THE £85,000 THRESHOLD, AND NOW APPLIES TO ALL VAT-REGISTERED BUSINESSES. FUTURE PHASES WILL INCLUDE INCOME TAX SELF-ASSESSMENT AND CORPORATION TAX.

COMPLIANCE WITH MTD IS A LEGAL REQUIREMENT. BUSINESSES THAT FAIL TO FOLLOW THE RULES RISK PENALTIES FROM HMRC. BUT BEYOND STAYING ON THE RIGHT SIDE OF THE LAW, THERE ARE CLEAR BENEFITS TO GOING DIGITAL. USING COMPATIBLE SOFTWARE HELPS REDUCE MANUAL ERRORS, KEEPS RECORDS ORGANISED, AND MAKES IT EASIER TO TRACK FINANCES IN REAL TIME.

USE THE FLOWCHART BELOW TO FIND OUT IF THIS APPLIES TO YOU AND WHEN:



BEING MTD COMPLIANT MEANS:

- HAVING A DIGITAL SOFTWARE TO MAINTAIN YOUR RECORDS THAT IS MTD COMPATIBLE, E.G. XERO, QUICKBOOKS, FREE AGENT
- FILING QUARTERLY TAX RETURNS OF A DIGITAL SUMMARY OF TRANSACTIONS TO HMRC
- AT THE END OF EACH TAX YEAR, HMRC WILL REQUIRE AN END-OF-YEAR SUBMISSION TO FINALISE YOUR TAX POSITION

IF YOU NEED HELP OR WOULD LIKE TO TALK THIS THROUGH PLEASE USE THE LINK OR QR CODE BELOW TO BOOK IN FOR A FREE, WITH NO OBLIGATION 20 MINUTE ONLINE SESSION. YOU WILL COME AWAY KNOWING WHAT YOU'RE LEGALLY REQUIRED TO DO, WHEN YOU HAVE TO DO IT BY AND A PLAN OF ACTION.



MAKING TAX DIGITAL - 20 MIN FREE CONSULTATION



ASK US ANYTHING HERE!



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